

Vibe Coding

a Web Application

Columbia University PDL

2026/04/22

Julian Berman

Hi.



`/in/julian-berman`



What is "Vibe Coding"?



← Post



Andrej Karpathy 
@karpathy

...

There's a new kind of coding I call "vibe coding", where you fully give in to the vibes, embrace exponentials, and forget that the code even exists. It's possible because the LLMs (e.g. Cursor Composer w Sonnet) are getting too good. Also I just talk to Composer with SuperWhisper so I barely even touch the keyboard. I ask for the dumbest things like "decrease the padding on the sidebar by half" because I'm too lazy to find it. I "Accept All" always, I don't read the diffs anymore. When I get error messages I just copy paste them in with no comment, usually that fixes it. The code grows beyond my usual comprehension, I'd have to really read through it for a while. Sometimes the LLMs can't fix a bug so I just work around it or ask for random changes until it goes away. It's not too bad for throwaway weekend projects, but still quite amusing. I'm building a project or webapp, but it's not really coding - I just see stuff, say stuff, run stuff, and copy paste stuff, and it mostly works.

6:17 PM · Feb 2, 2025 · **6.8M** Views

 1.4K

 6K

 33K

 17K



 Read 1.4K replies

Don't miss what's happening
People on X are the first to know.

Log in

Sign up

3 / 26

What is "Vibe Coding"?

```
open "https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Vibe_coding"
```

snippet +exec is disabled, run with -x to enable

Why does this matter for you?

- You don't need to be a software engineer to build software anymore
- The barrier went from "years of training" to "describe what you want"
- Your domain expertise is the valuable skill

Why does this matter for you?



[←](#) **Post**

 **Todd Saunders** 
[@toddsanders](#) 

I know Silicon Valley startups don't want to hear this.....

But the combination of someone in the trades with deep domain expertise and Claude Code will run circles around your generic software.

I talked to Cory LaChance this morning, a mechanical engineer in industrial piping construction in Houston. He normally works with chemical plants and refineries, but now he also works with the terminal

He reached out in a DM a few days ago and I was so fired up by his story, I asked him if we could record the conversation and share it.

He built a full application that industrial contractors are using every day. It reads piping isometric drawings and automatically extracts every weld count, every material spec, every commodity code.

Work that took 10 minutes per drawing now takes 60 seconds. It can do 100 drawings in five minutes, saving days of time.

His co-workers are all mind blown, and when he talks to them, it's like they are speaking different languages.

His fabrication shop uses it daily, and he built the entire thing in 8 weeks. During those 8 weeks he also had to learn everything about Claude Code, the terminal, VS Code, everything.

My favorite quote from him was when he said, "I literally did this with zero outside help other than the AI. My favorite tools are screenshots, step by step instructions and asking Claude to explain things like I'm five."

Every trades worker with deep expertise and a willingness to sit down with Claude Code for a few weekends is now a potential software founder.

Don't miss what's happening
People on X are the first to know.

[Log in](#)

[Sign up](#)

The Spectrum of Tools

Not all AI coding tools are the same.

They range from helping you type to building the whole thing for you.

Autocomplete

Predicts what you'll type next, like your phone keyboard but for code.

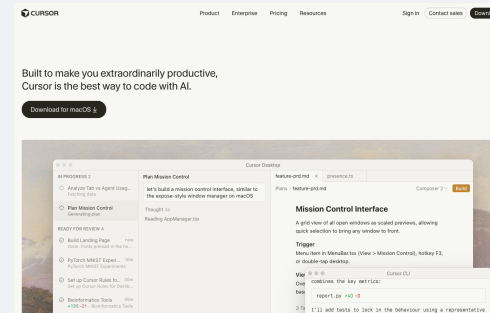
- **GitHub Copilot** (<https://github.com/features/copilot>)
- **TabNine** (<https://www.tabnine.com/>)

You still write the code – it just finishes your sentences.

AI-Assisted IDEs

A code editor with an AI chat built in.

You ask it questions, it suggests changes,
you accept or reject.

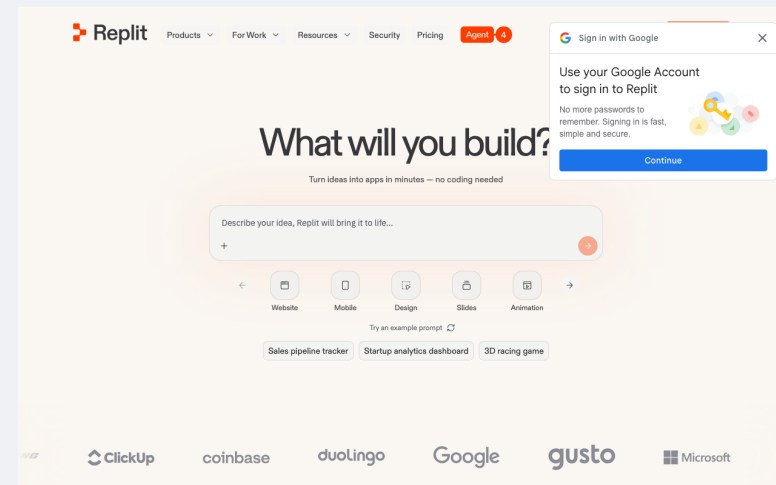
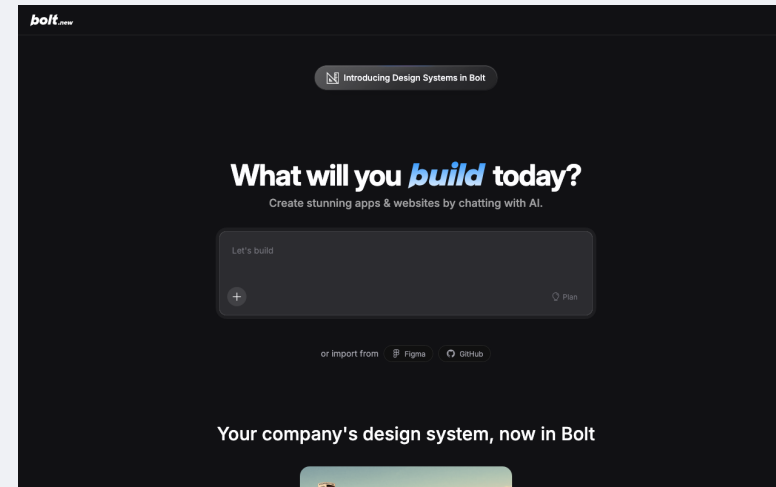


- Cursor (<https://cursor.com>)
- Windsurf (<https://windsurf.com>)

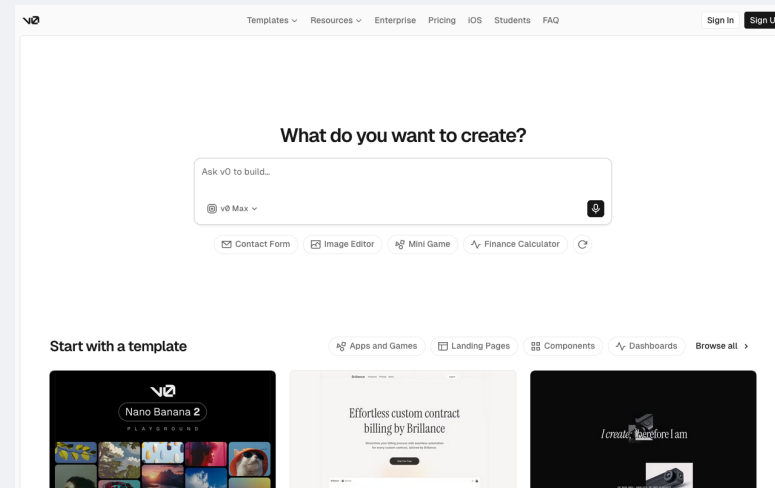
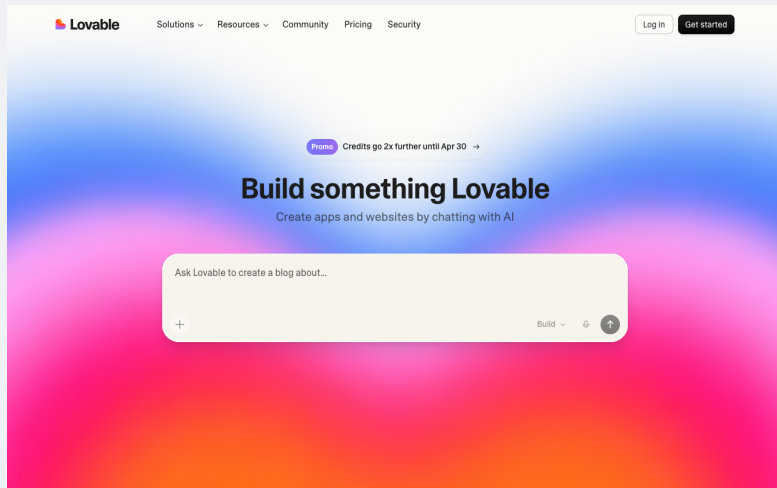
Web App Builders

Describe what you want, get a running app – in your browser, no setup.

This is probably the easiest place to start.



Web App Builders



Web App Builders

- **Bolt** (<https://bolt.new>) – bolt.new
- **Lovable** (<https://lovable.dev>) – lovable.dev
- **Replit** (<https://replit.com>) – replit.com
- **v0** (<https://v0.app>) – v0.app (by Vercel)

All have free tiers. Open a browser, describe your app, go.

Coding Agents

You describe what you want. The agent writes code, runs it, fixes errors, and iterates – on your computer.

- **Claude Code** (<https://docs.anthropic.com/en/docs/claude-code>) – what I use
- **OpenCode** (<https://opencode.ai>) – open source, works with free models
- **Codex** (<https://openai.com/index/codex/>) (OpenAI)
- **pi** (<https://github.com/badlogic/pi-mono/tree/main/packages/coding-agent>) – open source, multi-provider

More power, but requires some comfort with the terminal.

(It's also possible to run models entirely on your own hardware.)

Multi-Agent / Autonomous

Multiple AI agents collaborating on a task – planning, coding, reviewing.

- **Devin** (<https://devin.ai>)
- **OpenHands** (<https://github.com/All-Hands-AI/OpenHands>)

The frontier. Impressive demos, still maturing.

Vibe Coding vs. Agentic Engineering

Vibe Coding

The AI writes code, you don't look too closely.

Great for prototypes, personal projects, exploring ideas.

Agentic Engineering

The AI writes code, you review every change.

What professionals do for production software.

Vibe Coding vs. Agentic Engineering

```
open  
"https://simonwillison.net/guides/agentic-engineering-patterns/what-is-agentic-engineering/"
```

snippet +exec is disabled, run with -x to enable

Writing Good Specifications

If there's one skill that replaces "learning to code," it's this:

Learning to describe what you want clearly.

It's a Conversation

- You don't need to get it right on the first try
- The AI is a **brainstorming partner** – use it to refine your idea
- "Here's my rough idea... what am I missing?"
- "What would a user expect to happen when...?"
- "Is this specification clear enough to build from?"

Bad vs. Good

 Bad

"Make me a cooking website"

 Good

"A recipe organizer where I can:

- paste a URL and it extracts the recipe title, ingredients, and steps
- search my saved recipes by ingredient
- check off ingredients as I shop"

Practical Tips

- **Say what it should do**, not how to build it
- **Give examples** – "when I type 'chicken', it shows all recipes with chicken"
- **Start small**, then add features – don't specify everything at once
- **Ask the AI to review your spec** – "What's missing?"
- **Ask the AI to check its work** – "Is this secure? What happens if a user does X?"

What to Watch Out For

- It will confidently produce broken things – **always try running it**
- Don't paste sensitive or personal data into free tools
- It's better at common patterns than novel ones
- You still need to read what it produces, even if you didn't write it
- Layering more AI on top doesn't eliminate blind spots

Let's build something.

Demo

Coding Agent

Building an app with **Claude Code** in the terminal.

Web App Builder

Building the same app with a **web-based builder** – no setup.

Your Turn!

Open one of these in your browser and build something:

- [bolt.new](#)
- [lovable.dev](#)
- [replit.com](#)
- [v0.app](#)

Some ideas:

- A recipe organizer with ingredient search
- A campus event map
- A personal portfolio site
- A study group finder
- A budget tracker
- ... or whatever you've always wished existed

Instructions: (GitHub Classroom link here)

Further Reading

- Andrej Karpathy – "Vibe Coding" (<https://x.com/karpathy/status/1886192184808149383>)
- Simon Willison – Agentic Engineering Patterns (<https://simonwillison.net/guides/agentic-engineering-patterns/what-is-agentic-engineering/>)
- bolt.new (<https://bolt.new>) / lovable.dev (<https://lovable.dev>) / replit.com (<https://replit.com>) / v0.app (<https://v0.app>)
- Claude Code (<https://docs.anthropic.com/en/docs/claude-code>)
- OpenCode (<https://opencode.ai>)

Thanks!

Questions?